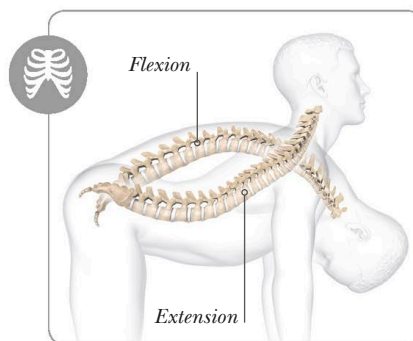


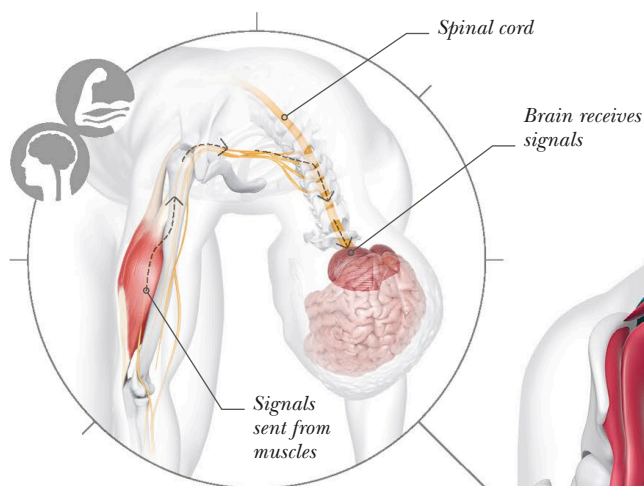
» CLOSER LOOK

Flowing from the flexion of Cat to the extension of Cow as you breathe deeply in and out improves your mind–body connection, as well as your sense of body awareness.



Spine flexion and extension

When your spine flexes, the front of your body engages while the back of your body stretches. When your spine extends, going into a backbend, the back of your body engages while the front of your body stretches. Your spinal extensors are the main players in this extension.



Mind–body connection

We often think of the brain as controlling our muscles. This is true: those motor signals tell your muscles what to do. However, your nervous system is a two-way conversation. Your body sends tons of sensory signals to your brain. Yoga improves the mind–body connection by encouraging you to listen to your body.

Ankles and feet are relaxed (in plantar flexion)

Middle finger is facing forward

Trapezius stretches

ANTERIOR-LATERAL VIEW OF CAT